

ployability as by starting salary. Active alumni networks worldwide are powerhouses for career growth, fundraising, curricular reform, and much more. Faculty often debate about the obsession with placements leading to a transactional culture, where short-term job outcomes trump long-term intellectual growth and critical thinking. Employers also stress the importance of emotional intelligence, teamwork, and resilience. These traits thrive in

environments where well-being and holistic development are emphasised, making balanced metrics a direct pipeline to workforce readiness.

Well-Being: Often Overlooked

The relentless focus on placements puts immense pressure on students. The growing competitiveness also takes a toll on the schools, which must constantly stretch resources to secure recruiter relationships

and meet high expectations, sometimes leading to extended strain and conflict between programmes and placements. Perhaps the most transformative addition to business education could be a focus on well-being. According to some reports, graduates who experience holistic care on campus report stronger adaptability, leadership maturity, and satisfaction in their careers.

Beyond Numbers

The move to balanced metrics is not just about scoring higher in ranking lists. It signals a profound shift towards transformational management education, a focus on the value of learning, crafting leaders who can manage complexity, demonstrate empathy, and drive innovation sustainably. As AI becomes integral to industries worldwide, its influence on business education will accelerate. AI promises to transform how students learn, collaborate, and apply knowledge, offering personalised learning experiences, immersive simulations, and real-time feedback that sharpen technical and analytical skills. Yet, as machines take on more tasks, the human-centric elements of education, empathy, ethics, adaptability, and leadership will become even more crucial.

A Better Future

As placement bells ring this season, the real scorecard belongs to schools that produce graduates who have learnt to learn, who thrive in complexity, adapt with grace, and give back with conviction. This is the future of Indian business education, and it promises to be richer, kinder, and more enduring than any package can measure. **BT**

Views are personal



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